

Property Sorting Court

Unit 6: Music Studio • Lesson 6-4 • EduWonderLab

UNIT 6 • LESSON 6-4 • TEACHER NOTES

Standard 6.EE.3

FORMAT Sort + justify (court)

TIME 25–30 min

GROUPING Pairs or teams

TOPIC Properties of Operations

STANDARD 6.EE.3

PREP LEVEL Light — print property cards and sort mat

Learning goal *I can identify properties of operations and explain them in words.*

Teacher setup

- Print one card set and sort mat per pair.
- Students sort each example by its property.
- To “win the case,” they explain the property in their own words.

Materials

Property cards, Sort mat, Evidence sentence frames, Pencil.

Differentiation & language support

- Property reference: commutative (order), associative (grouping), identity (stays same) (SPED).
- Sentence stem: “This shows the ___ property because ___.”
- ESOL: connect commutative to “commute = move.”

Key vocabulary (English / Español):

Term	Español	What it means
commutative	conmutativa	order does not change the result
associative	asociativa	grouping does not change the result
identity	identidad	a value that keeps a number the same

Quick teacher check: *Ask a pair to explain why Card 1 is commutative and Card 2 is associative.*

Property Sorting Court

Unit 6: Music Studio · Lesson 6-4 · EduWonderLab

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Your goal: *I can identify properties of operations and explain them in words.*

What you need

Property cards, Sort mat.

How to play

1. Read a property card.
2. Decide which property it shows.
3. Place it on the matching side of the sort mat.
4. Explain the property in words to win the case.

Property Examples

Sort each example by its property, then explain the property in your own words.

1. $3 + 5 = 5 + 3$	2. $(2 + 3) + 4 = 2 + (3 + 4)$
3. $7 \times 1 = 7$	4. $4 \times 6 = 6 \times 4$
5. $(2 \times 3) \times 5 = 2 \times (3 \times 5)$	6. $9 + 0 = 9$
7. $5(2 + 3) = 5 \times 2 + 5 \times 3$	8. $8 \times 0 = 0$

Record your work (property + explanation):

Explain your thinking

Explain the difference between the commutative and associative properties.

Sentence frame: *This shows the ___ property because ___.*

★ **Challenge:** Write your own example for the distributive property using a variable.

ANSWER KEY

Teacher copy — please do not distribute to students.

UNIT 6 • LESSON 6-4 • Property Sorting Court

Standard 6.EE.3

Answers

1. $3 + 5 = 5 + 3$ Answer: Commutative property of addition	2. $(2 + 3) + 4 = 2 + (3 + 4)$ Answer: Associative property of addition
3. $7 \times 1 = 7$ Answer: Identity property of multiplication	4. $4 \times 6 = 6 \times 4$ Answer: Commutative property of multiplication
5. $(2 \times 3) \times 5 = 2 \times (3 \times 5)$ Answer: Associative property of multiplication	6. $9 + 0 = 9$ Answer: Identity property of addition
7. $5(2 + 3) = 5 \times 2 + 5 \times 3$ Answer: Distributive property	8. $8 \times 0 = 0$ Answer: Zero property of multiplication

Teaching notes & look-fors

- Commutative = order; associative = grouping; identity = value stays the same.
- Card 7 is the distributive property; Card 8 is the zero property.